



Spend, spend, spend

As people become more prosperous, they have more money to spare after paying for necessities. They are encouraged to spend this on consumer goods.

Shopping spree

As industrialized societies prospered, so too did the retail sector—the shops and stores selling goods to the public. In industrial towns and cities, rather than visiting the rural farmers' markets, the workers and owners of the factories bought their goods from local shops. The centers of many urban areas soon became shopping districts, and today many have developed into indoor shopping malls. The retail industry has also continued to grow, alongside manufacturing, as people have more money to spend. Many of the individual retail businesses have grown into large department stores or supermarkets offering a range of different products, or into chain stores with branches in many towns. Today, in richer countries, there are also out-of-town superstores and shopping malls. Retail is now major business, employing huge numbers of people. It relies on customers, so competing retailers encourage consumers to buy their products. Because we are all potential